SHARENTING
(POSTING YOUR KIDS ONLINE):
A PARENT'S PLAIN-ENGLISH GUIDE

CYBER SAFETY GUY

We love sharing our kids' milestones. It's natural.
But once it's online, you lose control.
Here's what parents need to know.

81% of parents share photos of their kids online — Pew Research (2023)

1 IN 3 parents worry about their child's digital privacy — Pew Research (2023)

73% of teens say it's hard to control what parents post about them — Common Sense (2022)

FOREVER once it's online, it can be copied, shared and saved forever

1 WHAT IT IS
Sharenting is when parents post about their children online – photos, videos or personal details.

2 WHY PARENTS DO IT
To celebrate, connect with family & friends, capture memories and be part of online communities.

3 WHAT KIDS LIKE
Feeling proud and included when asked. Sharing achievements and fun moments.

4 KEY BENEFITS
Builds connections, creates memories, celebrates milestones and strengthens relationships.

5 THE RISKS
Loss of privacy, online safety risks, digital footprint, embarrassment or future impact.

6 THE CONVERSATION
Talk early. Listen. Respect boundaries. Agree together on what's OK to share – now and later.

WHAT PARENTS MIGHT SHARE

- Baby photos & videos
- Milestones & achievements
- Birthdays & celebrations
- Daily life & routines
- Locations & places
- School & activities
- Health & challenges
- Personal info (names, ages, relationships)

WHAT PARENTS NEED TO UNDERSTAND

1. It's not just a photo.
   It's your child's digital footprint.
2. Your child has rights too.
   They can't consent when they're young.
3. What's cute today could be embarrassing tomorrow.
   Think now, protect their future.

Think before you post. Your child's future self will thank you.

BY THE NUMBERS

72% of parents don't realise how long content stays online — Microsoft (2021)

57% of 10–17 year olds say it's too easy to share personal info online — Pew Research (2023)

39% of parents have shared something they later wished they hadn't — Kaspersky (2021)

81% of people say they review their privacy settings rarely or never — Pew Research (2023)

SAFETY SETTINGS & PRIVACY

WHAT EXISTS
- **Privacy Settings** — Limit who can see your posts.
- **Audience Controls** — Friends only, custom lists.
- **Tag Review** — Approve tags before they appear.
- **Location Controls** — Turn off location sharing.
- **Account Privacy** — Make accounts private.

WHAT TO CHANGE
- Set accounts to private.
- Limit who can comment or message.
- Turn off location tagging.
- Don't share personal details or schedules.
- Review tags and remove old posts if needed.

Find these in: Settings > Privacy (varies by platform).

STEP-BY-STEP: SHARE SMARTER

1. **Pause.** Do I need to share this?
2. **Check.** Would I be happy if my child posted this about me?
3. **Protect.** Remove names, dates, locations if possible.
4. **Ask.** Get your child's opinion as they get older.
5. **Adjust.** Use privacy settings.
6. **Review.** Look back and clean up old posts.

Small steps now. Big protection later.

RISKS WORTH KNOWING

- **Loss of Privacy** — Photos and details can be shared or saved forever.
- **Identity Risks** — Personal info can be used by others.
- **Safety Risks** — Strangers may track or contact your child.
- **Future Impact** — Old posts can affect education, jobs and reputation.
- **Embarrassment** — Kids may feel upset or lose trust.
- **Not Your Audience** — What you share may not be what others want to see.

THE 10-MINUTE CONVERSATION

- What's OK to share about you?
- What would you rather we keep private?
- How would you feel if someone shared that about you?
- Can we agree to check in together as you get older?

TRUST OVER SURVEILLANCE
Listen. Respect. Include them in the decision.

IF THINGS GO WRONG

STAY CALM & TAKE ACTION
- Don't panic.
- Talk to your child.
- Remove the content.
- Save screenshots or links.
- Review privacy settings.

REPORT & GET SUPPORT
- Report to the platform.
- Contact school if needed.
- Talk to a trusted adult.
- Contact Childline if you need support.

You did the best you could with the info you had.
You can always make better choices today.